

SCIENCE OF READING REVIEW: CROWLEY'S RIDGE COLLEGE

TRADITIONAL

On-Site Review: Date not reported

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

This report uses evidence from an on-site review to examine how an educator preparation program prepares candidates to teach reading using scientific reading instruction, as Arkansas requires of every approved program. It is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

The on-site reviews are carried out by Teacher Prep Inspection-US (TPI-US), an external review organization. TPI-US teams inspect coursework and course materials, observe instruction and clinical practice, review program data, and hold focus groups with candidates, faculty, mentor teachers, and school partners. Division of Elementary and Secondary Education staff participate in the review.

TPI-US rates the program in the three review areas of the Arkansas Literacy Review Framework:

- Review Area 1, "Quality of Literacy Coursework," is rated from course materials, syllabi, assignments, and observations of instruction.
- Review Area 2, "Quality of Field-Based Experiences," is rated from placement records, observation and feedback evidence, and focus groups with candidates, mentor teachers, faculty, and school partners.
- Review Area 3, "Quality of Performance Management and Continuous Improvement," is rated from program data systems, quality-control checkpoints, monitoring practice, and partnership evidence.

Every review area receives a rating. Depending on the framework version, the report may also rate each criterion; some earlier reports discuss every criterion without stating a separate rating for it. Performance Levels are defined as follows, in language drawn from the Arkansas Literacy Review Framework:

PERFORMANCE LEVEL	WHAT THE RATING MEANS
4 — EXCEEDS	Coursework and training CONSISTENTLY address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.
3 — MEETS	Coursework and training USUALLY address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.
2 — APPROACHING	Coursework and training INCONSISTENTLY address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.
1 — BELOW	Coursework and training RARELY OR DO NOT address the characteristics of high-quality instruction.

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REVIEW AREA PERFORMANCE LEVELS		
REVIEW AREA 1 LITERACY COURSEWORK	REVIEW AREA 2 FIELD-BASED EXPERIENCES	REVIEW AREA 3 PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT
BELOW	BELOW	BELOW
CRITERIA REVIEWED		
9	11	7
CORRECTIVE ACTION STATUS		
Corrective action determination issued for this review cycle. The Division identified 12 corrective actions for this program, of which 8 are required.		

PROGRAM INFORMATION

INSTITUTION NAME	Crowley's Ridge College
LOCATION	Paragould, Arkansas
PROGRAM REVIEWED	Educator preparation program, literacy
PATHWAY	Traditional
REVIEW FRAMEWORK	TPI-US Arkansas SOR Review Framework (2024)
REVIEWING BODY	Teacher Prep Inspection-US (TPI-US)
SITE VISIT DATES	Not reported

REVIEW AREA 1: QUALITY OF LITERACY COURSEWORK

REVIEW AREA 1 PERFORMANCE LEVEL	
BELOW 9 criteria reviewed	
CRITERION PERFORMANCE LEVELS	
Overview of the science of reading	Below
Concepts of print instruction	Below
Collaborative communication, oral language instruction	Below
Phonological and phonemic awareness instruction	Below
Phonics, orthography, automatic word recognition instruction	Approaching
Fluency instruction	Below
Vocabulary instruction	Below
Text comprehension instruction	Below
Writing instruction	Below
WHAT THE REVIEWERS FOUND	
Reviewers found that the required text for RDG 413 Foundations of Literacy did not align with science of reading standards and omitted models such as Scarborough's Rope, the Simple View of Reading, and the Four-Part Processing Model. In one observed session the instructor spent half the class on big books without explicit instruction on print concepts, left uncorrected a misconception about using illustrations for word identification, and conflated response to intervention tiers with vocabulary knowledge. Reviewers found that ELM 393 Literacy Assessment and Intervention promoted Reading Recovery and gave candidates little practice administering assessments or planning instruction from data. Coverage of phonics approached expectations, but the remaining eight criteria fell below.	
REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS	
• Prioritized professional development • Utilize supported text and materials • Revise and sequence coursework • Provide consistent application opportunities	
CORRECTIVE ACTIONS TARGETING THIS AREA	
Ten of the twelve corrective actions target this review area.	

REVIEW AREA 2: QUALITY OF FIELD-BASED EXPERIENCES

REVIEW AREA 2 PERFORMANCE LEVEL	
BELOW 11 criteria reviewed	
CRITERION PERFORMANCE LEVELS	
Selection of clinical placement schools	Below
Selection of cooperating teachers (mentor teachers)	Below
Opportunities to observe models of effective early literacy practice	Below
Field-based placements provide opportunities to use HQIM	Below
Responsibilities build to candidate readiness for full responsibility	Below
Opportunities to apply learning about multilingual children	Below
Opportunities to apply learning about students who experience difficulty reading	Below
Mentor teachers are skillful and can coach candidates	Below
Faculty and supervisors guide and evaluate candidates through training	Below
Quality of written and oral feedback	Below
Student engagement and candidate impact on student learning	Below
WHAT THE REVIEWERS FOUND	
Reviewers found no structured process for selecting placement schools or mentor teachers. Among the seven schools used, four of the six public schools held a C rating, one a D, and one an F, and student diversity ranged from 2 percent to 26 percent persons of color. The program had no documented mentor selection criteria and no record of the training mentors had completed or the instructional materials they used. Early field experiences were scheduled before candidates received foundational literacy training and fell in afternoon remediation sessions rather than the morning literacy block. The program produced no written feedback samples, and observed oral feedback addressed engagement rather than student learning.	
REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS	
• Develop a structure for clinical placement • Identify school partners • Mentor teacher selection • Revise all field experiences to align with coursework	
CORRECTIVE ACTIONS TARGETING THIS AREA	
Five of the twelve corrective actions target this review area.	

REVIEW AREA 3: QUALITY OF PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT AND CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

REVIEW AREA 3 PERFORMANCE LEVEL	
BELOW 7 criteria reviewed	
CRITERION PERFORMANCE LEVELS	
Quality of data the program collects and uses	Below
Internal quality control gates (or checkpoints) and intervention plans	Below
Quality of monitoring	Below
Monitoring coursework quality, teaching quality, and clinical connections	Below
Quality improvement planning	Below
Partnerships improve candidate experiences with HQIM	Below
Evaluation of partnerships for readiness to teach early literacy	Below
WHAT THE REVIEWERS FOUND	
Reviewers found data collection that was manual and compliance driven, with evaluation results kept in hard copy and no shared understanding of which data the program should gather. The program had no control gates confirming candidate readiness between phases and did not verify that candidates completed Praxis exams before the internship. A written improvement plan process existed in the handbook, but the program did not follow it. Because coursework quality went unmonitored, the program was unaware that its literacy textbooks were not aligned to the science of reading. No improvement plan existed for the most recent academic year, and district partnerships remained informal and unevaluated.	
REVIEW RECOMMENDATIONS	
• Develop a system for data collection and monitoring • Enhance data collection • Develop a comprehensive monitoring system • Establish control gates	
CORRECTIVE ACTIONS TARGETING THIS AREA	
One of the twelve corrective actions targets this review area.	

CORRECTIVE ACTION

Where a review identifies findings that require follow-up, the Division of Elementary and Secondary Education issues a corrective action determination. The Division selects from a standard set of corrective actions and marks each one required or recommended for the program. The recommendations under each review area above are the reviewers' advice; the actions below are what the Division has directed the program to do.

ACTIONS IDENTIFIED	REQUIRED	RECOMMENDED
12	8	4

The Division identified 12 corrective actions for this program, 8 required and 4 recommended. Required actions must be completed. Recommended actions are directed to the program as supports for the same findings. Some actions address more than one review area, so the per-area counts shown under each review area add to more than the total.

ACTIONS THE PROGRAM IS REQUIRED TO TAKE

CORRECTIVE ACTION	REVIEW AREA ADDRESSED	DESIGNATION	EVIDENCE REQUIRED
LETRS training or equivalent	RA1	REQUIRED	LETRS training certificates
RISE training, proficiency pathway	RA1	REQUIRED	RISE training certificates
Walk-through tool training	RA2	REQUIRED	Walk-through tool training certificates
Course revisions	RA1	REQUIRED	Revised course syllabi and observations
Cognitive coaching training	RA2	RECOMMENDED	Cognitive coaching training certificate
Inclusive practices training	RA1, RA2	RECOMMENDED	Inclusive practices training certificate
Full program revision	RA1-3	REQUIRED	Complete program revision submitted to Educator Preparation; interim visit
Defined partnerships and collaboration with dyslexia specialists at education cooperatives	RA1	REQUIRED	Certificate of completion from Southeast, Great Rivers, or Crowley's Ridge cooperative
Lesson plan internalization training (TNTP)	RA1	RECOMMENDED	Training certificate
Identify the HQIM in all partner districts and incorporate it into revised coursework	RA1	REQUIRED	Matrix of partner district HQIM and its inclusion in coursework
Small group instruction training, K-2 and 3-6	RA1, RA2	RECOMMENDED	Training certificate; participation through DESE and/or cooperatives
Literacy Foundations for English Learners book study (Elsa Cardenas-Hagan)	RA1	REQUIRED	Book study notes as documentation

OVERSIGHT

Each corrective action carries an evidence requirement, shown above. The program supplies the person responsible, the timeline for completion, and how each action will be used in the program when it submits its

corrective action plan to the Division. Those execution details are not recorded in the determination and are therefore not published here.

Sources: TPI-US Written Report & Recommendations, Crowley's Ridge College, fall 2024, conducted under the TPI-US Arkansas SOR Review Framework (2024). Crowley's Ridge College Corrective Action Plan, Arkansas DESE. Rating scale language quoted from the Arkansas Literacy Review Framework.